

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026; the Aug 5 catch-up was reviewed and stamped committed. **This version (August 6) is a light daily touch.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi said Aug 6 an "understanding in principle" has been reached with Oman on the Hormuz route map — entry and exit lanes are agreed, the most concrete progress yet, and a genuine step up from Aug 5's vaguer "still unsigned, 50-50" framing. The move stayed modest because a real new complication surfaced the same day: a fee dispute. Iran wants 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing ~3%; Washington wants zero. Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting, and the Jerusalem Post reports the proposed regime may not be feasible for the shipping industry. The re-rated scores in this version are **DRAFT**, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 6, 2026 (light daily touch on the Aug 5 committed set) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · every draft since shown for full lineage · Aug 5 committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 6 is today's light daily touch — awaiting my stamp

WINDOW	JUN	...	7/30	7/31	8/1	8/2	8/3	8/4	8/5	8/6	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	50	...	16	16	19	15	15	19	22	24	0.60	8	-2.50	Bear — still the heaviest drag in the set, but the route-map understanding is real progress, tempered by a new fee dispute
3 months	55	...	25	25	26	23	23	27	29	31	0.65	8	-1.98	Bear
6 months	62	...	37	37	37	37	37	39	40	41	0.70	8	-1.01	Mild Bear
1 year	75	...	55	55	55	55	55	56	56	56	0.65	8	+0.62	Mild Bull (dip-buy thesis intact but still thin)
3 years	85	...	77	77	77	77	77	77	77	77	0.55	8	+2.38	Bull

Draft P (Aug 6, light daily touch): 24 / 31 / 41 / 56 / 77 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact.
Full lineage: June committed 50/55/62/75/85 (Jun 19) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–Aug 4 path) → Aug 5 22/29/40/56/77 (first public Hormuz-deal terms, still unsigned — committed and stamped by Alex) → **Aug 6 24/31/41/56/77** (Iran-Oman route map agreed "in principle"; tempered by a newly-surfaced fee dispute) — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Aug 6: Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA "an understanding in principle has been reached on almost all the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" with Oman — corroborated by Bloomberg (two separate articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, Military.com, and Fortune. This is a genuine step up from the Aug 5 baseline's vaguer, still-unsigned framing: the route map itself — the geographic core of the arrangement — is now agreed. The move is kept modest for a real reason, not just caution: the same day, a material sticking point emerged. Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from ships transiting the Strait; Oman is discussing around 3%; Washington wants zero fees. Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting an agreement that would require ships to pay to transit, warning it would hurt European and Asian customers, and the Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal "not feasible for shipping industry." Trump called a potential fee joint-venture with Iran "a beautiful thing" (single-sourced quote, noted not scored). 12mo/36mo held pending an actual signed, operating agreement — a route map with an unresolved fee dispute is progress, not a deal.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. The route-map understanding rests on a named Iranian official's on-record statement (IRNA, primary) cross-checked against 6+ independent outlets; the fee dispute and industry pushback are independently corroborated (Fortune's shipping-lobby reporting, Jerusalem Post's feasibility sourcing). Quality itself is unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC closed at \$64,507.23 on Aug 6, essentially flat vs. Aug 5's \$64,661.55 — continued resilience even as the Iran signal keeps moving, a genuine, if partial, decoupling from Iran-specific headline noise.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 6, 2026

The crowd: reading today's news as unambiguous good news — "Iran, Oman close to Hormuz deal" is the dominant framing across Bloomberg, Al Jazeera, CBS, and others. That's real, but it's not the whole story: the same coverage that reports the route map "agreed in principle" also reports a fee dispute with real teeth (5-7% vs 3% vs 0%) and organized shipping-industry pushback that didn't exist yesterday.

Me: I'm moving up — 24% good-for-crypto at 1 month, up from 22% yesterday — because the route map is genuine, verifiable progress: it's the actual geography of the corridor, not just a diplomatic mood. But I'm not moving as far as the headlines alone might suggest, because a deal that's "agreed in principle" on geography but unresolved on money is not a deal — and the fee dispute is exactly the kind of detail that has killed prior rounds of this negotiation.

My edge: the crowd treats "an official said progress is close" as equivalent to "a deal is signed." I'm treating the route-map understanding and the fee dispute as two separate, simultaneously true facts, each earning its own weight — which is why this pillar's P moved up, not up sharply. The risk isn't the headline-of-the-day; it's whether the fee dispute gets resolved at all, and if so, at what rate, and whether the shipping industry actually complies once a rate is set. I watch that, not the "deal is close" narrative.

The Facts

As of August 6, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New Aug 6 facts appear first; the Jul 28-Aug 5 facts below are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing).

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reach an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle has been reached on almost all the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com. Trump said "a lot of progress had been made" and suggested an announcement could come soon.
- ★ **Aug 6 — a fee dispute is the real remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants zero fees (senior Iranian official, via Fortune). Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting the plan, warning it would hurt European and Asian customers who rely on the Strait for one-fifth of the world's oil. Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."
- **Aug 6 — outstanding issues beyond fees:** the mechanism for actually reopening the waterway and broader security arrangements remain unresolved per Al Jazeera's reporting.
- **Aug 6 — DOL jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1 came in at 199K**, with the prior week (ended Jul 25) revised up to 198K from 197K — logged here as macro/Iran-adjacent context; scored in the Fed & Macro pillar, not here.
- **BTC closed at \$64,507.23 on Aug 6** — essentially flat (−0.2%) vs. Aug 5's \$64,661.55.

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the pause. Separately, a Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: a separate tanker was hit by an unknown projectile off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first coordination meeting in Riyadh — a genuine structural de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation came after "the perimeters of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump responded by calling Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was said to be forming.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an arrangement: inbound traffic via a northern lane in Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.

- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — ballistic missiles/drones, described as a "surprise attack," all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them." CNN's Jul 30 live coverage explicitly frames this as "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, Nineveh, Basra, Kirkuk, Karbala, and Diyala — **20 killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). Fire contained, no injuries. No group has claimed responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the renewed strikes and widening war (Fortune). A previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's public claims of productive talks. A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one failed 49-47.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced dispute (NYT officials, Rep. Massie on record) over whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Jul 30: the Strait "will remain closed."
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crashed crypto on Iran-specific grounds — BTC closed at **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

Today added the most concrete evidence yet that the diplomatic path is real: an agreed route map, not just a mood.

BTC closed at **\$64,507.23** on Aug 6 — essentially flat vs. Aug 5. If the fee dispute resolves and a full agreement is signed and holds, the upside case shifts from "the market shrugs off the next attack" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium currently priced into Iran's near-term signal unwinds for real" — a bigger, more durable prize than another muted-reaction data point. Still thin and still unsigned — the fee gap (5-7% vs 3% vs 0%) is a real negotiating distance, not a formality; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **"Agreed in principle" on a route map is not a signed agreement — and the fee dispute is the kind of detail that kills deals.** 5-7% vs 3% vs 0% is not a rounding error; it's a real negotiating gap, and eight shipping-lobby groups organizing opposition on day one suggests this could drag on or collapse entirely.
- **The pattern all week (and before) has been progress-then-complication.** Aug 1's quiet night gave way to Aug 2's tanker attacks; Aug 4's canceled strike came with a bulker attack the same day; now Aug 6's route-map understanding comes with a fee dispute the same day. Each positive signal this pillar has scored has arrived paired with a negative one — treat that pattern, not any single day's headline, as the base rate.
- **Iran's Deputy FM is not Iran's final word.** A "senior official" statement to IRNA is a real, on-record primary source, but it is not the same as a ratified, government-binding agreement — prior cycles in this war have seen official statements walked back or superseded within days.
- **Trump's "beautiful thing" comment about a fee joint-venture is itself a complication, not reassurance.** If Washington's actual negotiating position (zero fees) conflicts with what Trump is publicly floating (a fee-sharing arrangement), that's an internal US inconsistency layered on top of the Iran-Oman gap.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a route map with an unresolved fee dispute is not obviously more durable than any of the prior lulls that broke within days.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 6, 2026.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Aug 6 — POSITIVE, confirmed primary	Iran-Oman "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map (entry/exit lanes agreed)	Drove today's 1mo/3mo/6mo nudge up — already IN this draft
Fired Aug 6 — NEW COMPLICATION, confirmed	A fee dispute: Iran wants 5-7% of cargo value, Oman ~3%, the US wants zero; 8 shipping-lobby groups protesting	Kept today's move modest — the real remaining obstacle
Pending — the real trigger	Whether the fee dispute is resolved and a full agreement is actually signed	Resolved and signed = re-rate up meaningfully; talks stall over fees = re-rate back down
Fired Aug 4 — NEGATIVE, confirmed (carried forward)	A bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait — active attacks continued even as diplomacy advanced	Still the reason near-term P stays well below a coin flip
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance — 14 members, 43 nations represented at a first Riyadh coordination meeting	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural development, distinct from any single day's headline
Unresolved	The mechanism for actually reopening the waterway and broader security arrangements remain outstanding per Al Jazeera, beyond just fees	Watch for whether these resolve alongside or after the fee question
By ~Aug 16, 2026	Formal MoU withdrawal or 60-day window expires unsigned (not fired)	Diplomacy dead — re-rate 1/3/6-month down
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line, re-leveled: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of US strikes on Iran proper, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. As of Aug 6 we are not past that line. The equivalent upside flip: a signed, durable Hormuz reopening — with the fee dispute actually resolved, not just the route map agreed — that holds past its first week without a new shipping attack. Nothing so far has cleared that bar.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — AUGUST 6, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY TOUCH) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 24 / 31 / 41 / 56 / 77 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

The Aug 5 catch-up (22/29/40/56/77, committed by me) remains the last stamped values. Today's light touch nudges up (22/29/40/56/77 → 24/31/41/56/77) on Iran's Deputy FM confirming an "understanding in principle" with Oman on the Hormuz route map — real, verifiable progress on the actual geography of the corridor. The move stays modest because the same day surfaced a genuine new complication: a fee dispute (Iran 5-7%, Oman ~3%, US 0%) that eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting, and industry sources telling the Jerusalem Post the proposed regime may not be workable.

1-year and 3-year held unchanged — a single day of Iran headlines, whichever direction, isn't meant to move the long-horizon read by design.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the near-term margin widened again today, the second straight improvement. But the real test is still ahead: whether the fee dispute actually resolves and a full agreement gets signed. The real risk paths — a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of strikes on Iran proper, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 — remain unfired.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Light daily touch, August 6, 2026, on the Aug 5 committed set.

- ★ **Iran's Deputy FM confirmed an "understanding in principle" with Oman on the Hormuz route map** (IRNA, primary; corroborated by Bloomberg x2, CBS, Al Jazeera x2, Euronews, Military.com) — the geographic core of an arrangement, agreed for the first time.
- ★ **A fee dispute surfaced the same day:** Iran wants 5-7% of cargo value, Oman ~3%, the US wants zero; 8 shipping-lobby groups are already protesting (Fortune); Jerusalem Post reports industry sources calling the plan potentially infeasible.
- **DOL jobless claims: 199K (week ended Aug 1), prior week revised to 198K** — logged here for context; scored in the Fed & Macro pillar.
- **BTC closed at \$64,507.23 (Aug 6)** — essentially flat vs. the Aug 5 close of \$64,661.55.
- **Score re-rates (Aug 5 committed → Aug 6):** 1mo 22 → **24** · 3mo 29 → **31** · 6mo 40 → **41** · 1yr 56 → **56** (held) · 3yr 77 → **77** (held) — real progress on the route map, tempered by a real new complication on fees. Draft only — awaiting my stamp.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 6, 2026 (light daily touch; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked today) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) and "Iran, Oman Reach Agreement on Proposed Strait of Hormuz Shipping Route" (Aug 5) · CBS News — live updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz Is Becoming A Fee-And-Permission Regime" (background, Jul 28) · Fast Company / DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO-sourced reporting via globalsecurity.org — second disabled tanker off Musandam · Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint US-Israeli strike, "perimeters of a deal" (Aug 4) · iransitrep.com — bulker struck and blacked out in the Strait (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday (Aug 5).
- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by CBS News and Foreign Policy · Al Jazeera — drone strike on Egypt's Damietta port, corroborated by CNBC and Times of Israel · CNN — "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries" (Jul 30) · Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- **July 11-13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack drones, Jul 12) · Al Jazeera (multiple, Jul 12-13) — Hormuz-closed declaration, shipping-intelligence data via Windward, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned · Naharnet and Iran International — Iran/Oman/Qatar median-lane two-route corridor proposal · Business Recorder and RTÉ (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmaeil Baqaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — GFS Galaxy attack and rescue (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaieteur News — Iranian Health Ministry casualty figures (17 killed / 115 wounded, unverified government claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000-63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks.
- **July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (referenced Jul 11).
- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Al Jazeera — second-night strikes & the peace process (July 9) · Gulf News — Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00-76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · Insurance Journal — traffic near halt, war-risk 2-6% of hull value (July 9) ·

The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · (*Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source*) · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).

- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polymarket fetch failed twice this week (July 13); "US invades Iran before 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.